

NEVER AN ADEYEMI

EPISODE 9: THE REPORT

PALMFIRE SEASON 1

Screenplay draft

Based on Mario's final story brief and story bible

Contemporary Lagos romance with stakes

FADE IN:

INT. TOBI'S APARTMENT - DAWN

Tobi arranges the evidence that survived: the original agreement, Afolabi's signed statement, Mrs. Aina's carbon copy and the waiver.

He calls Mr. Obi.

TOBI

I am going to the police. The historic ownership dispute is civil. The waiver and the burned documents are not.

MR. OBI (V.O.)

You should not do this alone.

TOBI

I am not asking you to protect me.

MR. OBI (V.O.)

I am not. I am protecting the truth from becoming another man's story.

Tobi places the file in a plain bag.

CUT TO:

INT. POLICE ECONOMIC CRIMES DESK - DAY

INSPECTOR ABIODUN listens while Tobi and Mr. Obi sit opposite him.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

The historical ownership dispute is civil.

MR. OBI

We understand.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

The current allegations are coercion and destruction of material evidence.

TOBI

Yes.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

Where is the destroyed evidence?

TOBI

In the family fireplace.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

That is a beginning, not a conclusion.

TOBI

Then take the beginning.

Mr. Obi places the waiver on the desk.

MR. OBI

It required my daughter and me to leave the family's life permanently.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

Did you sign?

MR. OBI

No.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - STUDY - AFTERNOON

Inspector Abiodun arrives with an officer. Kunle and Yewande stand beside Chief's desk. Mrs. Adeyemi remains near the window.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

We need statements regarding an estate settlement and destruction of evidence.

KUNLE

This is a family dispute.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

The family part is why it took so long to report.

YEWANDE

Tobi has turned grief into revenge.

TOBI

I turned the waiver into a record.

KUNLE

Mother, tell them what happened.

MRS. ADEYEMI

You burned his letter.

Kunle looks at her, betrayed.

MRS. ADEYEMI

Your father wanted the truth to enter this house.

KUNLE

He wanted to leave us with a scandal.

MRS. ADEYEMI

He left me with a choice.

Inspector gestures toward the door. Kunle and Yewande leave with the officers.

CUT TO:

INT. EXECUTOR'S OFFICE - LATE AFTERNOON

Mrs. Eze reviews Afolabi's statement, the original agreement and the police report.

MRS. EZE

The estate can record what it was prevented from seeing.

TOBI

Even if the original letter is gone?

MRS. EZE

A copy has a source. A witness has a voice. Neither is the same as the missing paper, but both matter.

MR. BALOGUN

The formal offer remains valid.

MR. OBI

I have had a lifetime to consider it.

IFY

You do not have to decide today.

MR. OBI

I have decided what I will not let them decide for me.

He looks at the acceptance form but does not sign.

MR. BALOGUN

The formal meeting is tomorrow morning.

CUT TO:

EXT. OBI FAMILY HOME - EVENING

Ify sits on the veranda. Tobi approaches without a car and stops at the gate.

TOBI

The police took the statements.

IFY

Did you tell them you were still an Adeyemi?

TOBI

I told them I was there when the evidence was destroyed.

IFY

That is the distinction you should have made
at the memorial.

TOBI

I know.

IFY

My father has a decision tomorrow.

TOBI

He should make it without the family
standing over him.

IFY

Will you stand there?

TOBI

Only if you want me to.

Ify looks at the open latch.

IFY

Tomorrow is not forgiveness.

TOBI

I know.

IFY

It is a door.

She leaves the latch open. Tobi does not enter.

FADE OUT.